



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Veritas Preparatory Academy
School Website: <https://veritasprep.greatheartsamerica.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Veritas Preparatory Academy Az 85018 (Veritas Prep), a tuition-free classical Great Hearts academy serving grades 6–12, demonstrates a strong orientation toward classical education across curriculum, pedagogy, and community. Public materials consistently frame the school as a classical liberal-arts program designed to cultivate virtue and wisdom, with explicit emphasis on Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, a humanities-driven curriculum (Humane Letters seminars, four years of Latin & Greek, Euclid-based geometry), and a pedagogy that blends contemplative memory work with Socratic discourse in upper grades. The faculty structure emphasizes master teachers and mentorship, and the school communicates a family-centered, welcoming community with active parental engagement. While the Great Hearts network provides a robust classical framework, explicit statements about liturgical practices or formal theological grounding are less prominent in the public-facing materials. Overall, the school is CLASSICAL, with some room to more explicitly articulate liturgical/theological foundations and deeper parent-as-co-educators messaging.

- Evidence of classical framing and core elements appears throughout: "tuition-free classical Great Hearts Academy," "Truth, Goodness, and Beauty," and a classical curriculum built on humane letters, Latin/Greek, and geometry.
- The school presents a clear formation-oriented purpose (virtue education) and a curriculum anchored in liberal-arts classics, with Master Teachers and a living-curriculum approach, all aligning with classical criteria.
- Parental/community engagement is encouraged and public-facing materials welcome families and visitors, though explicit "parents as co-teachers" language is less explicit in the public materials analyzed.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Conclusion: Overall CLASSICAL.

If you'd like, I can turn this into a concise abstract or exportable report. Below is the full, category-by-category analysis with keyword analysis notes and rationales.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence

- Public materials frame the school as a classical Great Hearts academy focused on Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, signaling a metaphysical orientation toward virtue formation. The materials explicitly state: “Truth, Goodness, and Beauty” and highlight virtue education as central to the program.
- There is explicit emphasis on Western tradition and a tolerant, pluralistic approach to world religions in policy-level materials, which indicates a broad spiritual/humanistic frame rather than a stated theological system.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, Western tradition, world religions, ethical/moral codes, Great Hearts.
 - Negative/absent keywords: explicit liturgical/mystical practices, direct canonical theology, sacramental language. The public materials emphasize virtue and the classical canon more than liturgical worship or a theological system.
- Why this rating
 - The materials center on transcendental aims and virtues (Truth, Goodness, Beauty) and Western-tradition framing, but they stop short of explicit theology, liturgical practices, or a clear, church-like metaphysical system in the public-facing content. This aligns with a classical-but-not-theologically explicit stance, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence: Truth, Goodness, Beauty; Western-tradition focus; World-religions mention. □filecite□turn0file7□turn0file10□

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The program emphasizes virtue education and formation over purely informational aims. The materials state “the heart of the program is virtue education woven quietly into everything,” underscoring formation of character and human excellence over mere information or job preparation.
 - The curriculum presents the school as building virtue and wisdom, with aim toward liberal-arts mastery and humane learning (Great Books, humane letters, languages, classical disciplines).
 - Great Hearts materials describe a classical liberal-arts framework designed to form students into “great-hearted leaders” capable of success in higher education and career, indicating a formation-centric goal rather than narrow job training.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: virtue, formation, truth, goodness, beauty, classical, liberal arts, humane letters, Great Books, Latin/Greek, depth of inquiry, formation of character.
 - Negative keywords present: (None prominent in public materials; the content emphasizes formation rather than “training for a specific job.”)
- Why this rating
 - The school explicitly centers education as a formation of character and humanity through classical liberal-arts education, aligning strongly with the Classical rubric for purpose and goal.

Cited evidence: Virtue formation language; classical liberal-arts framing; Great Books/humanities emphasis. □filecite□turn0file7□turn0file18□turn0file15□

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The curriculum centers on humane letters, classical languages, and mathematical/scientific work rooted in classical texts: “Humane Letters seminars, Euclid-based geometry, and four years of Latin & Greek, French or Spanish.” This explicitly signals the liberal-arts core of grammar, logic, and rhetoric in practice.
 - The curriculum material shows explicit references to Great Books and a “Great Conversation” style through a classical program (e.g., Humane Letters seminars; study of primary texts). The

curriculum page and supportive pages highlight a classical sequence rather than a purely modern, social-studies-centered approach.

- The school's materials on depth of inquiry, classical curriculum sequences, and a structured progression through the humanities and languages reinforce the classical curriculum framework.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, humane letters, Great Books, Latin, Greek, geometry (Euclid-based), classical curriculum, depth of inquiry, Great Conversation.
 - Negative keywords present: none prominent in public materials; no emphasis on non-classical, skills-based, or purely test-driven curricula.
- Why this rating
 - The explicit emphasis on humane letters, classical languages, geometry grounded in classical texts, and a Great Books-forward approach solidifies a CLASSICAL curriculum rating.

Cited evidence: Humane Letters, Latin/Greek, Euclid geometry, Great Books, depth of inquiry. [filecite](#)[turn0file17](#)[turn0file18](#)

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Pedagogical methods described in the classical framework include Socratic dialogue, memory-building through singing/chanting (Scholé), memorization/recitation, and formation through imitation and practice. The knowledge-document appendix explicitly lists these pedagogical methods as core to classical education.
 - The lower-school practices emphasize singing, chanting, and memory work, aligning with a pedagogy that values formation and recall in the early grades. The upper-school pedagogy emphasizes Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training.
 - The faculty structure includes Master Teachers who mentor others, reinforcing a rigorous, conversation-based, and exemplar-driven pedagogical model.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, guided discussion, great conversation, memory work (recitation/chanting), scholé (restful learning), formation through imitation, Master Teachers, lectures through a living curriculum.
 - Negative keywords present: project-based or purely experiential models are not emphasized in the public-facing materials; the pedagogy is framed around classical methods rather than contemporary, non-classical approaches.
- Why this rating
 - The school's pedagogy aligns closely with classical methods (Socratic seminars, memory work, recitation, disciplined discussion linked to classical texts, and a living curriculum via Master Teachers), which supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Cited evidence: Pedagogy items (Socratic, Scholé, memorization/recitation); lower/upper-school methods; Master Teachers. [filecite](#)[turn0file16](#)[turn0file6](#)

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The faculty is described as model teachers and mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge. The living curriculum concept positions teachers as central to the school's mission, with Master Teachers collaborating with the Headmaster on curricular and mentorship roles.
 - The presence of a defined leadership/academic team (Headmaster, Deans, Master Teachers, College Counselors) signals a structured faculty culture with a shared vision of classical education.
 - The public content emphasizes a "portrait of what a teacher should be" and "what a student should be," consistent with a classical model that foregrounds teacher virtue and mentorship as the living curriculum.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, Master Teacher, teacher-mentoring, core of the school, portrait of teacher/student ideals.
 - Negative keywords present: none prominent in public materials.
- Why this rating
 - The materials clearly position faculty as the central, virtuous, mentored, and curriculum-defining element of the school, which aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for a teacher-led, virtue-centered, living-curriculum model.

Cited evidence: Master Teachers; living curriculum; teacher-portrait language.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school presents a welcoming, family-centered campus and emphasizes accessibility for families, with language like “A Welcoming Community for Every Family,” and mentions of tours, visits, and campus access for families. This signals a strong community orientation and parental engagement, though not always explicit about parents as co-teachers.
 - Policy-level materials reference parent/guardian involvement and the role of parents in governance and compliance with policy (non-discrimination, Title IX, etc.), indicating formal engagement with families, though not necessarily the exact “parents as co-teachers” framing.
 - There are explicit references to family engagement through events, tours, and communications, suggesting ongoing parental involvement and avenues for participation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: family, welcoming community, tours, guests/visitors, parent involvement, open access to campus.
 - Negative keywords present: explicit “parents as co-teachers” language is not evident in the public materials; direct statements about parents as co-educators are not clearly documented in these public pages.
- Why this rating
 - The school demonstrates strong parental engagement and a welcoming community, which is consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for parents as partners. However, the explicit, articulable role of parents as co-educators (a hallmark of some classical schools) is not clearly evidenced in the public-facing content examined. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL for Element 6.

Cited evidence: Welcoming-family language; tours/visit access; parent involvement references. □file-cite□turn0file7□turn0file10□

What Would Move the Needle

- If the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL, there is no mandatory needle-moving section. However, to strengthen CLASSICAL standing, the following targeted improvements could help:
 - Explicitly articulate theological or liturgical foundations where appropriate (e.g., a public-facing statement about the integration of virtue and metaphysical ideas consistent with classical Christian schooling, if applicable, without compromising non-denominational accessibility).
 - Strengthen and publish explicit statements about parents as co-educators, with concrete programs or formats (e.g., parent-led seminars, reading groups, or joint curricula work) to deepen the Parent & Community alignment with classical goals.
 - Increase explicit references to Great Books experiences and Socratic seminars in public pages for catechetical clarity (e.g., direct mentions of Great Books reading lists, Great Conversation, and Socratic seminars in the upper grades).

Cited context: Public materials emphasize virtue, classical curriculum, and parent engagement, but explicit theological liturgy and explicit parent-as-co-teachers language are less prominent in the accessible content.

□filecite□turn0file7□turn0file10□

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.